

Health and Social Care

(AAQ) OCR Level 3 Alternative Academic Qualification Cambridge Advanced National in Health and Social Care (Extended Certificate)

This course is designed to provide an understanding of the many and varied aspects of health and social care services and builds applied skills. The Level 3 AAQ provides a grounding that can be used to access higher education, further training, or employment within the sector. An interest in pursuing a future career in, or related to, health or social care is important.

You will have the opportunity to apply what you learn to real-life contexts, such as:

Recommending support for individuals, presenting advice and guidance and communicating and building relationships. This qualification will also help you develop independence and confidence in using skills that are relevant to the sector and that prepare you for progressing to university courses.

You will develop transferable skills including:

- Communicating and collaborating effectively with individuals
- Creating and presenting/delivering information to an individual.
- Researching topic areas and recording research sources, then using them to interpret findings and present evidence.
- Recommending care and support for individuals.
- Problem solving health and social care problems for others.

The **Level 3 AAQ Extended Certificate** is equivalent to one A Level. It involves studying six units over two years – Four of which are internally assessed NEA's (assignments) and two of which are externally assessed (examinations).

40% exam + 60% NEA (assignment)

There are two compulsory exam units:

- Principles of Health and Social Care
- Anatomy and Physiology for Health and Social Care

There are two compulsory NEA units and two NEA units chosen by the teachers.

- Person centred approach to care
- Supporting people with mental health conditions
- Supporting people in relation to sexual health, pregnancy, and postnatal health
- Supporting healthy nutrition and lifestyles

Assessment: The internally assessed units (NEAs) involve assignments. These are internally marked and moderated by OCR. External assessment involves written examinations.

Overall award levels

At the end of the two years, you will receive a Pass, Merit, Distinction and Distinction*. Pass is equivalent to a grade E at A level, Merit is equivalent to a grade C, Distinction to a grade A and Distinction* to a grade A*.

UCAS points will be available.

Entry requirements:

General Sixth Form entry requirements. The scientific demands of the 'Anatomy and Physiology' exam unit needs to be fully considered by any student wishing to take this course.

Career Links

This can lead to further study at university or to careers in health or social care settings such as nursing, elderly care, nursery nursing, social work, early years education, mental health, special educational need support work.

For more information please contact Mrs Milsom or Mrs Griffiths (Science).